

Qubo R700

Best air purifier under ₹20,000

In most Indian cities, you need an air purifier to breathe quality air at home. And today, if you search online, you get plenty of options across budgets. Recently, I made a listicle for air purifiers under Rs 20,000, and one brand that stood out for its offering is Qubo. The Here Group company recently launched the R700 air purifier and sent us a unit for review. It retails at around Rs 15,000 in India, and on paper, it is a very competent product. It boasts a CADR of 460 m³/h, coverage area of up to 700 sq. ft., True HEPA H13 filtration, BLDC motor, app support, and voice assistant integration. But specifications alone do not make a good air purifier. In real-world usage, factors like airflow behaviour, purifying quickness, noise, maintenance cost, and day-to-day convenience matter. So, I have used the Qubo R700 for a few weeks and here's my experience.

DESIGN

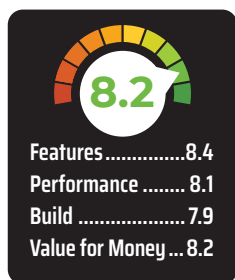
Most air purifiers I have come across are in white or off-white colour. The Qubo R700 at least tries to look different with its matte black cylindrical design, which isn't just an aesthetic choice, but the cylindrical form factor with pores on the surface allows for 360-degree air intake. This also means that regardless of the way it is placed, there are some openings to intake impure air.

That said, over time, the black finish does attract smudges, dust, dirt and stains. You can easily wipe and clean it.

It weighs very little, too. The day it was delivered on a bike, it was easy to carry it upstairs to the first floor. At about 4.1kg, the R700 can be easily moved around the house, if needed.

On top, you have the air vents for pure air throw and a control panel with

₹16,990



comprehensible text and icons. The control panel is a touch interface. You get toggles for Power On/Off, Fan Speeds, including sleep mode, Timer, Auto Mode, and QSenseAI. The difference between the latter two is that Auto Mode regulates fan speed

between 1, 2 and 3 levels, whereas QSenseAI cycles between Sleep Mode and other fan speeds based on your usage and indoor air quality. It is slightly more efficient than regular Auto Mode.

In the centre, there is a PM 2.5 indicator which changes in real-time. And besides the white-coloured lighting of these icons and PM 2.5 numerical indicator, there is also a colour-based indicator: Red for very poor quality, Yellow for poor air quality and Green for satisfactory air quality.

Out of the box, the filter will already be installed inside the purifier, but it will be covered in plastic. To remove it, unlock the bottom cover by rotating

it anticlockwise. Take out the filter, remove the plastic cover, place the filter back inside, and lock the cover by rotating it clockwise. Then plug in the purifier and start using it.

FILTRATION PERFORMANCE

The Qubo R700 purifier claims a CADR of 460 m³/h with room coverage of up to 700 sq. ft. These figures are impressive for the price. I placed it in our bedroom, which measures about 150 sq. ft., and it mostly sat there unintrusive, unless we were lighting up dhoop batti in the pooja room nearby or during the night. While sleeping, the lights on the top can be distracting, so I would always manually enable sleep mode.

You don't have to always tap the touch panel to control the R700 purifier. The Qubo app also does the same job, perhaps even more conveniently. Say, you are in the living room or on the bed, and want to toggle any mode/settings, you can do that with the app. It works over 2.4GHz Wi-Fi. The pairing is straightforward. When it works, it works reliably. But, sometimes, say when QSenseAI puts the purifier in standby mode, then when the purifier detects impure air and starts working, the app still shows the purifier as off.

I tested it with dhoop batti lit in a few different scenarios:

- Lit it for about 15 feet away in an open 550 sq. ft. space, and the R700 took under 10 minutes to reduce PM2.5 by 50 per cent.
- Burned the dhoop batti for 2 minutes in a closed 160 sq. ft. room, and the purifier took under 5 minutes to reduce PM 2.5 by 50 per cent.
- If the dhoop batti is placed really close to the purifier, then it does bring down the pollution level in the room even quicker.

Dhoop batti has dense smoke, and if it takes anywhere around 10-20 minutes for near-normal air, then that is decent. In essence, this test shows the purifier can ramp up quickly and noticeably reduce indoor particulate matter (PM) levels within a short period.